Tim Everard

Tournament Operations Manager

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PROFILE

Tournament operations leader with 15 years' experience running live tournaments, events and the field-based teams behind them. At BLAST, led a six-person department and line-managed tournament staff delivering 60+ flagship events and 300+ qualifiers in 13 countries, with €12m+ in budgets and 2,000+ freelancers booked, contracted and scheduled across each event. Hands-on with venue arrangements and equipment, staffing rotas and scheduling, event budgets, and the health and safety and safeguarding side of live events as a Designated Safeguarding Lead and first aider. Rebuilt department processes and documentation for clearer ownership and accountability. Comfortable managing field-based teams and travelling to deliver events on-site, with a full driving licence.

60+	300+	2,000+	€12m+	13
flagship esports events	qualifiers	freelancers	in budgets	countries

EXPERIENCE

Head of Esports Operations

Jun 2023 – Oct 2026

BLAST

- Led a six-person department running tournament operations across every BLAST ecosystem, including CS2, Dota 2, Brawl Stars, Fortnite, Rocket League and Rainbow Six
- Rebuilt how the department works, with clearer ownership, accountability and proper documentation
- Designed and built the department's own tools for tournament operations, event and equipment tracking, freelancer calendars, bookings and contracting, and event budgets and deadlines
- Brought Team Operations into the department, so all online and offline player management and support sat with one team
- Wrote the business case for a departmental OPEX budget covering equipment renewal, software and cross-event costs
- Costed and pitched new tournament work with the product and commercial teams
- Set technical requirements for commercial partnerships

KEY SKILLS

Tournament operations
Tournament and player operations, event logistics, site visits, bootcamps

Team leadership
Line management of field-based teams, people management, process and SOP documentation

Staffing and scheduling
Freelancer booking, contracting and payments, rotas, staffing schedules

Budgets and admin
Budgets, invoices, business cases, event administration

Venues and vendors
Venue arrangements, equipment procurement, vendor management

Safety and compliance
Designated Safeguarding Lead, first aider, fire marshal, health and safety

Systems and tooling
Airtable, Google Workspace, Microsoft Office

CERTIFICATIONS

First Aid at Work	2022
Safeguarding Lead (DSL)	2021
Working at Heights	2018
Moving Head Maintenance	2018
Manual Handling	2018
Fire Marshal	2018
PAT Testing	2016
IPAF	2012

References available on request.

Tournament Operations Manager

Jan 2020 – Jun 2023

BLAST · Contractor to Mar 2021, then permanent

- Managed tournament equipment and staffing budgets across CS:GO, Dota 2, Apex Legends, FIFA, Fortnite and Rainbow Six
- Booked and managed tournament operations freelancers for internal, external and online productions
- Arranged venues and equipment for team bootcamps
- Approved equipment and staffing invoices, and decided when to hire, buy or repair tournament kit
- Main tournament-level contact for FACEIT, ESIC and BLAST Premier teams
- Designated Safeguarding Lead and first aider at live events

Broadcast Freelancer

Jan 2018 – Jan 2020

Self-employed · Alongside Jam Television

- Crewed broadcasts and live events for clients including BLAST Pro Series, ESL UK and ESL Germany, BBC, Sky Sports, ITV, Immediate Media, NATS, Big Ben (WRC), Altitude Angels and Create Broadcasting
- Worked in the gallery as technical director, producer and graphics operator on live shows
- On-stage admin at esports events, and consulted on production and technical setups for clients

Broadcast and Studio Manager

Mar 2018 – Jan 2019

Jam Television · Birmingham

- Hired freelancers and ran staff rotas to keep a 24-hour TV channel on air, including holiday cover and emergency call-outs
- Controlled the studio budget, including equipment purchasing
- Designed a multi-camera TV studio from scratch, bought the equipment, and managed installation and testing
- Trained staff on studio equipment and workflows
- Managed suppliers, invoice approval and day-to-day maintenance, including software and hardware updates

Production Manager

Jul 2015 – Dec 2017

ESL UK · Leicester

- Hired freelance crew, managed rotas and supervised internal and external staff on live shows
- Controlled production budgets and purchased studio and event equipment
- Built and set up the technical infrastructure for two ESL UK studios
- Managed production for both studios and at external events including MCM, EGX and Formula E
- Worked in the gallery as technical director, producer and graphics operator on live broadcasts
- Trained crew on equipment and workflows, and ran equipment hire, installation, testing and maintenance

Senior Lighting and Event Technician

Jun 2012 – Jun 2015

Dorking Halls · Casual Technician Mar 2010 – Jan 2011

- Controlled the equipment and training budget, and ran in-house lighting training
- Carried out PAT testing on the venue's electrical equipment
- Maintained specialist kit for a theatre and two cinemas, from lighting and audio desks to 35mm and digital projectors
- Covered whatever the show needed, working as audio engineer, stage hand or stage manager
- Set up and ran touring and in-house performances
- Head of lighting for The Darkness's support act, support lighting engineer for Enter Shikari, head of audio and lighting for Lee Mack, and comedy tours with Jimmy Carr, Dara Ó Briain and Ed Byrne